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July 3, 2024

Docket Nos.: 50-321

NL-24-0240

U. S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission
ATTN: Document Control Desk
Washington, D. C. 20555-0001

Edwin I. Hatch Nuclear Plant – Unit 1
Licensee Event Report 2024-003-00
Unit 1 Reactor Core Isolation Cooling (RCIC) System Inoperable Due to
Mispositioned Link

Ladies and Gentlemen:

In accordance with the requirements of 10 CFR 50.73 (a)(2)(i)(B), Southern Nuclear Operating Company hereby submits the enclosed Licensee Event Report.

This letter contains no NRC commitments. If you have any questions, please contact the Hatch Licensing Manager, Jimmy Collins, at 912.453.2342.

Respectfully submitted,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "MB Busch", written over a horizontal line.

Matt Busch
Vice President – Hatch

MSB/JMH

Enclosure: LER 2024-003-00

Cc: Regional Administrator, Region II
NRR Project Manager – Hatch
Senior Resident Inspector – Hatch
RTYPE: CHA02.004

Enclosure to NL-24-0240
LER 2024-003-00

**Edwin I. Hatch Nuclear Plant – Unit 1
Licensee Event Report 2024-003-00**

**Unit 1 Reactor Core Isolation Cooling (RCIC) System Inoperable Due to
Mispositioned Link**

Enclosure

LER 2024-003-00



LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)

(See Page 2 for required number of digits/characters for each block)

(See NUREG-1022, R.3 for instruction and guidance for completing this form
<http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/doc-collections/nuregs/staff/sr1022/r3/>)

Estimated burden per response to comply with this mandatory collection request: 80 hours. Reported lessons learned are incorporated into the licensing process and fed back to industry. Send comments regarding burden estimate to the FOIA, Library, and Information Collections Branch (T-6 A10M), U. S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission, Washington, DC 20555-0001, or by email to Infocollections.Resource@nrc.gov, and the OMB reviewer at: OMB Office of Information and Regulatory Affairs, (3150-0104), Attn: Desk Officer for the Nuclear Regulatory Commission, 725 17th Street NW, Washington, DC 20503. The NRC may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, a collection of information unless the document requesting or requiring the collection displays a currently valid OMB control number.

1. Facility Name	☒ 050 ☐ 052	2. Docket Number	3. Page
Edwin I. Hatch Nuclear Plant Unit 1		00321	1 OF 2

4. Title
Reactor Core Isolation Cooling (RCIC) System Inoperable Due to Mispositioned Link

5. Event Date			6. LER Number			7. Report Date			8. Other Facilities Involved	
Month	Day	Year	Year	Sequential Number	Revision No.	Month	Day	Year	Facility Name	Docket Number
05	08	2024	2024	- 003 -	00	07	03	2024		☐ 050
									Facility Name	☐ 052

9. Operating Mode	10. Power Level
MODE 1	99.7%

11. This Report is Submitted Pursuant to the Requirements of 10 CFR §: (Check all that apply)

☒ 10 CFR Part 20	☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(vi)	☒ 10 CFR Part 50	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ii)(A)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(viii)(A)	☐ 73.1200(a)
☐ 20.2201(b)	☐ 20.2203(a)(3)(i)	☐ 50.36(c)(1)(i)(A)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ii)(B)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(viii)(B)	☐ 73.1200(b)
☐ 20.2201(d)	☐ 20.2203(a)(3)(ii)	☐ 50.36(c)(1)(ii)(A)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(iii)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ix)(A)	☐ 73.1200(c)
☐ 20.2203(a)(1)	☐ 20.2203(a)(4)	☐ 50.36(c)(2)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(iv)(A)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(x)	☐ 73.1200(d)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(i)	☒ 10 CFR Part 21	☐ 50.46(a)(3)(ii)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(A)	☒ 10 CFR Part 73	☐ 73.1200(e)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(ii)	☐ 21.2(c)	☐ 50.69(g)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(B)	☐ 73.77(a)(1)	☐ 73.1200(f)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(iii)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(A)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(C)	☐ 73.77(a)(2)(i)	☐ 73.1200(g)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(iv)		☒ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(B)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(D)	☐ 73.77(a)(2)(ii)	☐ 73.1200(h)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(v)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(C)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(vii)		

☐ OTHER (Specify here, in abstract, or NRC 366A).

12. Licensee Contact for this LER

Licensee Contact	Phone Number (Include area code)
Jimmv Collins - Licensina Manaager	9124532342

13. Complete One Line for each Component Failure Described in this Report

Cause	System	Component	Manufacturer	Reportable to IRIS	Cause	System	Component	Manufacturer	Reportable to IRIS

14. Supplemental Report Expected					15. Expected Submission Date			Month	Day	Year
☒ No	☐ Yes (If yes, complete 15. Expected Submission Date)									

16. Abstract (Limit to 1326 spaces, i.e., approximately 13 single-spaced typewritten lines)

At 1133 EDT on 5/8/2024, with Unit 1 operating at 99.7% power in MODE 1, maintenance was performing a surveillance on Reactor Core Isolation Cooling (RCIC) and identified an open electrical link that should have been in the closed position. This link being open defeated the RCIC High Reactor Water Level trip function. The High Reactor Water Level trip is a Technical Specification (TS) required function, without which RCIC is inoperable. At 1725 on 5/8/2024 the link was closed, restoring the High Reactor Water Level trip function and RCIC operability.

Causal analysis determined that, due to a gap in the usage of human performance (HU) tools, the link was inadvertently left open after restoration of a tagout on 3/8/2024 during the refueling outage. Corrective actions for this event focused on management reinforcement of HU Tool usage.

**LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)
CONTINUATION SHEET**

(See NUREG-1022, R.3 for instruction and guidance for completing this form
<http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/doc-collections/nuregs/staff/sr1022/r3/>)

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1. FACILITY NAME Edwin I. Hatch Nuclear Plant Unit 1	☒ 050	2. DOCKET NUMBER 00321	3. LER NUMBER		
	☐ 052		YEAR 2024	SEQUENTIAL NUMBER 003	REV NO. 00

NARRATIVE**EVENT DESCRIPTION**

At 1133 EDT on 5/8/2024, with Unit 1 operating at 99.7% power in MODE 1, maintenance was performing a surveillance on Reactor Core Isolation Cooling (RCIC)(EIIS: BN) and identified an open electrical link that should have been in the closed position. This link being open defeats the RCIC High Reactor Water Level trip function. The High Reactor Water Level trip is a Technical Specification required function, without which RCIC is inoperable.

EVENT CAUSE ANALYSIS

The link being inadvertently left open was due to a gap in the usage of HU tools such as task preview, validating assumptions, and having a questioning attitude when manipulating plant equipment.

SAFETY ASSESSMENT

There were no actual safety consequences as a result of this event. At any time while the link was open, RCIC would have started at its low reactor water level setpoint and injected as required. If vessel level continued to rise during RCIC injection moisture carryover into the main steam lines could, over the course of time, lead to RCIC turbine damage. However, the RCIC mission time is only 8 hours and RCIC can be manually secured at any time if needed. Furthermore, RCIC is not credited in the safety analysis.

This event is reportable per 10 CFR 50.73 (a)(2)(i)(B) as a condition prohibited by TS. The RCIC system was inoperable between 3/8/2024 until the link was closed on 5/8/2024. During this time, Unit 1 entered the mode of applicability on 3/10/2024 @ 1150 and then exited the mode of applicability due to cooling down from a reactor scram on 3/11/2024 @ 1903. Then Unit 1 entered the mode of applicability again after the subsequent startup on 3/17/2024 @ 1928. The allowable TS 3.5.3.A (RCIC inoperable) completion time of 14 days plus the TS 3.5.3.B completion time of 12 hours to be in MODE 3 was exceeded on 4/1/2024 @ 0728.

Additionally, the High Pressure Coolant Injection (HPCI)(EIIS: BJ) pump was operable when RCIC was inoperable except from 3/10/2024 @ 2331 until 3/11/2024 @ 0027 for performance of a surveillance test. This overlapping time of RCIC and HPCI inoperabilities did not exceed the TS 3.5.1.G completion time of 12 hours to bring the unit to MODE 3 when both RCIC and HPCI are inoperable.

All low pressure ECCS systems were operable during the time RCIC was inoperable.

CORRECTIVE ACTIONS

At 1725 on 5/8/2024 the link was closed, restoring the High Reactor Water Level trip function and RCIC operability. Immediate corrective actions for this event focused on management reinforcement of HU Tool usage. Additionally, actions are in progress to conduct oral boards to reinforce the use of HU Tools.

PREVIOUS SIMILAR EVENTS

None.